

# Catherine Vance

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Operations executive with 18 years in industrial manufacturing, the last seven running multi-plant operations of up to 1,400 people. I turn around underperforming plants, build leadership teams that stay, and connect the shop floor to the numbers the board cares about. Most recently led a \$40 million modernization that raised on-time delivery from 81% to 96%.

## CORE SKILLS

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- Operations: Multi-plant leadership, lean manufacturing, plant turnarounds
- Finance: P&L ownership to \$310 million, capital planning, cost reduction
- People: Building leadership teams, union relations, safety culture
- Growth: New product launches, capacity expansion, acquisition integration

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Harrowfield Pump Company

Charlotte, NC

*Vice President of Operations*

Jan 2019 – Present

- Lead three plants and two distribution centers with 1,400 employees and a \$310 million operating budget, reporting to the CEO
- Planned and delivered a \$40 million modernization across all three plants on schedule and \$2.3 million under budget
- Raised on-time delivery from 81% to 96% and cut warranty claims by 38% over four years
- Brought the recordable injury rate from 4.1 to 1.6 by putting safety walks and near-miss reporting at the center of every plant meeting
- Rebuilt the plant leadership team, and every manager hired since 2020 has stayed
- Integrated an acquired valve business into our operating system in nine months, keeping every major customer and all of its 120 employees

### Ironbriar Equipment Works

Greenville, SC

*Plant Director*

Mar 2014 – Dec 2018

- Ran a 600-person plant making hydraulic components for construction equipment, with annual output of about \$140 million
- Turned the plant from a \$6 million loss to a \$9 million profit in three years through lean projects, a new shift pattern and better scrap control
- Negotiated two labor agreements with no strikes and half the grievances
- Opened a second assembly line for a new product in 11 months, ahead of plan
- Introduced tiered daily meetings from the shop floor to the plant staff, so problems reached the right level within a day

### Brassfork Tooling

Dayton, OH

*Operations Manager*

Jun 2010 – Feb 2014

- Managed production, maintenance and quality for a 220-person tooling plant
- Introduced daily production boards and a weekly cost review that cut overtime by 30%
- Led the plant's first ISO 9001 certification, passed with no major findings
- Moved maintenance to a planned schedule and cut unplanned downtime by 25%
- Hired and trained the plant's first team of production supervisors drawn from the shop floor
- Set up a cross-trained maintenance crew that covered all three shifts

- Cut scrap from 4.8% to 2.1% of material cost with operator-led problem solving
- Ran the plant's capital budget of about \$3 million a year
- Worked with sales on quoting rules that ended money-losing rush orders

**Harmon & Pike Manufacturing**

Dayton, OH

*Industrial Engineer*

Jul 2006 – May 2010

- Redesigned two assembly cells, raising output per labor hour by 22%
- Built the plant's standard cost model, still in use when I left
- Ran time studies and line balancing for a new product launch with the engineering team

**EDUCATION**

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**Larkbriar University**

Raleigh, NC

*Master of Business Administration**May 2013***Cardinal Ridge University**

Columbus, OH

*Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering**May 2006***BOARD AND AFFILIATIONS**

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- Board member, Carolinas Manufacturing Roundtable, since 2021
- Advisory board, Larkbriar University Center for Operations Excellence, since 2019